ECONOMIC ATTITUDE SURVEY I
TOP LINE QUESTIONNAIRE
January 30, 1992

DATES OF INTERVIEWING - January 18 - 21, 1992
NUMBER OF INTERVIEWS - 1,500
MARGIN OF ERROR = + or - 3

INTRODUCTION: Hello, I am _____ calling for the Princeton Survey Research Associates from Princeton, New Jersey. We are conducting a telephone opinion survey for a leading news organization. I'd like to ask a few questions of the youngest male, 18 years of age or older, who is now at home (IF NO MALE, ASK: May I please speak with the oldest female, 18 years of age or older, who is now at home?)

My first question is...

1.Do you approve or disapprove of the way George Bush is handling his job as President?

44	Approve
44	Disapprove
12	Don't know
100	

2.Next, I'd like you to think about the upcoming presidential campaign. I am going to read to you the names of some possible candidates for the Democratic nomination for President. After I read all the names would you tell me which one you would most like to see nominated as the Democratic parties candidate for President? (ROTATE LIST)

5	Former Massachusetts Senator Paul Tsongas (SONG-gus)
10	Nebraska Senator Robert Kerrey
7	Iowa Senator Tom Harkin
16	Former California Governor Jerry Brown
19	Arkansas Governor Bill Clinton

DO NOT READ:

3	Other: Specify
40	Don't know
100	

3.Would you like to see George Bush re-elected President in 1992 or would you prefer that a Democratic candidate win the election?

39	Bush re-elected
44	Prefer Democrat
17	Don't know
100	

4.What is the biggest problem facing you and your family these days? (OPEN END. DO NOT READ.)

7	No problems
19	Economy/Recession (general)
28	Unemployment/Low paying jobs
24	Not enough money/Paying bills/Making ends meet
10	High prices/High cost of Living and housing
8	Taxes/High taxes
4	Child care/Cost of education
10	Health care/High cost of health insurance
4	Family/Personal/Health problems
4	Social problems
4	Other
4	Don't know

Total exceeds 100% due to multiple answers

5.In what ways, if any, is life for you and your family improving? (OPEN END. DO NOT READ.)

12	Financially
8	Career/Job opportunities
*	World peace
4	Children/Grandchildren growing or progressing
9	Fine/Improving (general)
3	Educational progress
5	Family unity/Relationships
2	Spiritually/Religiously
3	Health/Medical
4	Alive/Secure/Retiring
2	New home/Just moved here
2	Other
43	None
14	Don't know

Total exceeds 100% due to multiple answers

6.In what ways, if any, is life for you and your family becoming more difficult? (OPEN END. DO NOT READ.)

17	Inflation/High cost of living/Prices
1	Housing/Rent
16	Unemployment/Low paying jobs/No raises
22	Lack of money/Paying bills
5	Taxes/High taxes
4	High cost of education /Quality of education
9	Health care/High cost of health insurance
5	Health problems/Aging
5	Family problems/Lack of time with family
2	Crime/Drugs
6	Other
23	None
8	Don't know

Total exceeds 100% due to multiple answers

7.How would you rate your own personal financial situation. Would you say you are in excellent financial shape, good shape, only fair shape or poor shape?

4	Excellent shape
32	Good shape
45	Only fair shape
18	Poor shape
1	Don't know
100	

8.In an average month, approximately how much money do you and your family need to make ends meet? (NOTE: IF NECESSARY REMIND RESPONDENT THAT AN ESTIMATE IS ALL WE ARE LOOKING FOR. IF RESPONDENT GIVE A RANGE CALCULATE THE MID-POINT AND RECORD BELOW.)

$ _____ (RECORD ACTUAL DOLLAR AMOUNT, ROUND TO CLOSEST $10)

Don't Know

Mean dollar amount $ 1936

9.How much do you and your family worry about being able to make ends meet -- a lot, some, only a little, or not at all?

27	A lot
32	Some
23	Only a little
17	Not at all
1	Don't know
100	

10.Over the course of the next year, do you believe you and your family's financial situation will be improving a lot, improving some, becoming a little worse or becoming a lot worse?

9	Improving a lot
46	Improving some
19	Becoming a little worse
5	Becoming a lot worse
16	Staying about the same - VOL.
5	Don't know
100	

11.Thinking about the money you owe on credit cards and installment loans (excluding your mortgage), would you say you ... (READ. DO NOT ROTATE LIST.)

7	Owe a lot more than you can afford?
14	Owe a little more than you can afford?
32	Owe about what you can afford?
19	Or owe less than you can afford?
16	(DO NOT READ) Do not have any debts - VOL.
11	(DO NOT READ) No credit cards or loans - VOL.
1	Don't know
100	

12.Are you employed full-time, part-time or aren't you employed? (IF R SAYS NOT EMPLOYED ASK: Is that because you are retired, because you choose not to work, because you've been laid off or fired and are looking for work, or because you've been laid off or fired and have given up looking for work?)

50	Employed full-time
11	Employed part-time
19	Not employed - Retired
12	Not employed - Choose not to work
6	Not employed - laid off/fired and looking
1	Not employed - laid off/fired and not looking
1	No answer
100	

13.Do you think the chances are high, low or almost zero that some time in the next 12 months an adult in your family will be out of work and actively looking for a job?

22	High
24	Low
37	Almost zero
6	(DO NOT READ) Someone out of work now
7	(DO NOT READ) Retired
4	Don't know
100	

ASK ONLY OF EMPLOYED PEOPLE:

14.Do you now earn enough money to lead the kind of life you want, or not?

n= 1,002

39	Yes
61	No
*	Don't know
100	

IF NO IN QUESTION 14 ASK:

15.Do you think you will be able to earn enough money in the future to lead the kind of life you want, or not?

n= 1,002

34	Yes
22	No
5	Don't know
61%	

ASK ALL:

16.Thinking now about job opportunities where you live, would you say there are plenty of jobs available in your community or are jobs difficult to find?

12	Plenty of jobs available
79	Jobs are difficulty to find
6	Lots of some jobs, few of others - VOL.
3	Don't know
100	

* = less than one-half of one percent

ASKED OF EMPLOYED ONLY

17.How would you rate the financial condition of the company or organization that employs you. Would you say it is in excellent financial shape, good shape, only fair shape or in poor shape?

n= 1,002

22	Excellent shape
39	Good shape
24	Only fair shape
12	Poor shape
3	Don't know
100	

ASK ALL:

18.How would you judge business conditions in your community? Would you say that local businesses are in excellent shape, good shape, only fair shape or poor shape?

2	Excellent shape
25	Good shape
51	Only fair shape
20	Poor shape
2	Don't know
100	

19.What's your impression about the real estate market in your community? Is it very easy, easy, difficult or very difficult for people in this community to sell their homes?

3	Very easy
19	Easy
51	Difficult
18	Very difficult
9	Don't know
100	

20.In general, do you feel prices in the stores are going up a lot, up a little, down a little, or down a lot?

32	Going up a lot
48	Going up a little
8	Going down a little
2	Going down a lot
7	Staying about the same - VOL.
3	Don't know
100	

21. In general, how easy is it for you to afford the things in life that you want -- very easy, easy, difficult or very difficult?

4	Very easy
35	Easy
46	Difficult
12	Very difficult
3	Don't know
100	

22. How easy is it for you and your family to afford (INSERT ITEM) -- very easy, easy, difficult or very difficult? (CONTINUE WITH REST OF LIST. ROTATE LIST. ALWAYS HAVE ITEM H FOLLOW G.)

		Very Easy	Easy	Diff.	Very Diff.	NA	DK	Tot
a.	Food	7	68	21	3	*1		100
b.	Clothing	6	55	30	6	21		100
c.	Housing	7	55	27	7	31		100
d.	Automobile	5	46	31	11	61		100
e.	Health care	6	43	29	16	42		100
f.	Cost of higher education	1	13	32	22	302		100
g.	Health insurance	7	39	31	17	42		100
h.	Other kinds of insurance	4	37	38	12	72		100
i.	Child care	2	15	14	5	631		100
j.	Taxes	2	33	45	13	43		100
k.	Saving for retirement	2	22	37	23	142		100
l.	Heating oil, gas and electric	4	55	31	7	12		100

23.How satisfied are you with each of the following -- very satisfied, satisfied, dissatisfied or very dissatisfied? (READ AND ROTATE LIST)

	Very Satis	Satis	Dis-Satis	Very Dis-Satis	DK	NA
a. The housing you are able to afford	10	68	16	5	1	*
b. Your ability to save or invest	3	31	42	18	4	2
c. The amount of money you have for going out	4	47	30	13	5	1
d. The kind of car you can afford	7	56	24	9	4	*
e. Your ability to purchase new home furnishings and appliances	3	45	32	13	6	1
f. The amount of money you have for vacations	3	33	37	20	6	1

ASK ONLY IF EMPLOYED:
24.Please tell me if the following statements about working applies to you. First, (READ AND ROTATE LIST)

n= 1,002

	Yes	No	Don't Know	Tot.
a. I may have to relocate for better job opportunities	32	67	1	100
b. I am staying in my job mostly to maintain my benefits	37	63	*	100
c. I am working at a second job to make ends meet	14	86	*	100
d. I am taking courses or training to further my job opportunities	32	67	0	100
e. I feel I need additional training in order to advance in my job	41	59	*	100
f. I could easily find another job in my line of work if I wanted to	53	45	2	100
g. There are many opportunities for advancement within the company where I currently work	31	67	2	100
h. We need more than one salary in this household to make ends meet	68	32	*	100
i. My employer would eliminate my job if it could	30	67	3	100
j. In this community there are many low paying jobs available but few that pay well	73	22	5	100
k. My job is threatened by foreign competition	15	84	1	100

ASK Q. 25 IF EMPLOYED (Q. 12=1 OR 2) OR IF LAID OFF/FIRED (Q. 12=5

OR 6) THERE ARE TWO FORMS OF THIS QUESTION.

FORM 1:

25. Thinking about your current job and future job opportunities, please tell me if you feel the following people and organizations are helping or hurting you get ahead in your job or career. First, is (INSERT ITEM) helping you a lot, helping, hurting or hurting you a lot in your job or career? (ROTATE LIST.) What about (INSERT ITEM) is this helping or hurting you in <u>your</u> job or career? (BE SURE TO USE THE PROMPT EVERY FEW ITEMS TO REMIND RESPONDENT THAT THE FOCUS IS ON THEIR OWN JOB OR CAREER)

	Help A Lot	Help	Hurt	Hurt A Lot	No Effect on Job	NA	DK
n= 546							
a. President Bush	2	21	28	12	24	7	6
c. The Republican party	1	19	27	11	22	8	12
d. The Democratic party	2	22	20	5	25	9	17
k. Japan	1	7	25	16	34	12	5
l. European competitors	1	8	23	8	39	15	6
m. Laws that restrict sex or race discrimination on the job	4	22	11	4	41	15	3
n. Laws that restrict age discrimination on the job	3	21	12	4	41	15	4
q. Corporate mergers and reorganizations	1	14	23	8	34	15	5
n= 547							
b. The Congress	2	18	36	14	17	6	7
f. Unions		5	22	19	5	30	15	4
h. Immigrants working legally in the United States	1	12	25	8	37	13	4
i. Immigrants working illegally in the United States	*	2	27	21	33	13	4
j. Current laws that govern the amount of imports		2	10	29	14	31	9	5
o. Government spending programs		2	18	32	19	18	5	6
p. Wage scales of overseas workers		1	8	23	8	36	11	13
r. Bankers and lenders		5	22	25	8	25	9	6

ASK MEN ONLY: n= 626						
s. Women who work at your company or organization	10	38	6	1	31	12
2						
ASK WOMEN ONLY: n= 467						
t. Men who work at your company or organization	7	29	12	3	30	15
4						

ASK ALL:
26.Do you own or rent your own home?

65	Own
26	Rent
4	Other arrangement
5	Don't know
100	

IF OWN IN Q. 26 ASK QUESTIONS NEXT FOUR QUESTIONS. ALL OTHERS GO TO Q. 31.

27.Has the value of your home increase or decreased over the past few years. Would you say it increased a lot, increased a little, decreased a little, or decreased a lot?

n= 995

20	Increased a lot
43	Increased a little
14	Decreased a little
7	Decreased a lot
8	Remained the same - VOL. - GO TO Q. 29
8	Don't know - GO TO Q. 29
100	

IF INCREASE (1 OR 2) OR DECREASE (3 OR 4) IN Q. 27 ASK 28.

28.How much of an effect has this had on your financial situation? Has it had a great deal of effect, some effect, not too much effect or no effect at all on your financial situation?

n= 839

Increased	
7	Great deal of effect
17	Some effect
20	Not too much of an effect
29	No effect at all
1	Don't know
Decreased	
4	Great deal of effect
6	Some effect
6	Not too much of an effect
9	No effect at all
1	Don't know
100	

29.In the future, do you think the value of your home will increase a lot, increase a little, decrease a little or decrease a lot?

n= 995

14	Increased a lot
52	Increased a little
14	Decreased a little
3	Decreased a lot
7	Remained the same - VOL.
10	Don't know
100	

30.Thinking about your financial assets, would you say that the value of your home represents ... (READ)

n= 995

33	All or most of your personal financial worth?
35	About half of your financial worth?
25	Or less than half of your financial worth?
7	Don't know
100	

ASK ALL:

And finally, just a few background questions for statistical purposes...

31.In politics today, do you consider yourself a Republican, Democrat or Independent?

29	Republican -- SKIP TO 33
31	Democrat -- SKIP TO 33
35	Independent
1	Other
4	Don't know
100	

32.As of today do you lean more to the Republican Party or more to the Democratic Party?

13	Republican
14	Democratic
5	Other
8	Don't know - GO TO Q. 34
40	

33.How often would you say you vote (Democratic/Republican)? All

the time, most of the time or only some of the time?

Vote Republican	
8	All the time
20	Most of the time
12	Only some of the time
2	Don't know

Vote Democratic	
13	All the time
17	Most of the time
13	Only some of the time
2	Don't know
13	Not applicable
100	

34. In the election in November 1988, when George Bush ran against Michael Dukakis, did things come up which kept you from voting, or did you happen to vote? For whom?

45	Bush
20	Dukakis
1	Other
2	Voted, don't remember for whom
28	Did not vote
4	Don't know
100	

35. Are you now registered to vote in your precinct or election district?

77	Yes
21	No
2	No answer
100	

36.How many people are their living in your household, including yourself?

14	One
32	Two
20	Three
20	Four
8	Five
3	Six
3	Seven or more
*	No answer
100	

36a.How many children under the age of 18 are there in this household?

18	One
15	Two
6	Three
1	Four
2	Five or more
57	None
1	No answer
100	

37.How many adults in this household, including yourself, work full or part time?

34	One
36	Two
7	Three
3	Four or more
19	None
1	Don't know
100	

38.What is your marital status -- are you married, divorced, separated, widowed, or never been married?

59	Married,
10	Divorced,
2	Separated,
9	Widowed, or
19	Never been married
1	No answer
100	

39.Are you or is your spouse a member of a labor union?

9	Yes respondent is
6	Yes spouse is
2	Yes both
81	Neither are
2	Don't know
100	

40.What is your age?

_____ years

97 or older
Don't know

41.What is the last grade or class that you completed in school? (DO NOT READ)

6	None, or grade 1 - 8
13	High school incomplete (Grades 9 - 11)
34	High school graduate, Grade 12
5	Technical, trade, or business after high school
20	College/university incomplete
13	College/university graduate
8	Some post-graduate training for an advanced degree, for example, a master's degree, Ph.D., law or
1	No answer
100	

42.Which of the following best describes the place where you live now? (READ)

16	In a large city?
24	In a suburb near a large city?
38	In a small city or town, or
21	In a rural area?
1	Don't know
100	

43.Are you, yourself, of Hispanic origin or descent, such as Mexican, Puerto Rican, Cuban, or some other Spanish background?

5	Yes
94	No
1	No answer
100	

44.What is your race? Are you white, black, or some other? (IF

RESPONDENT SAYS HISPANIC ASK: Do you think of yourself as a white hispanic or a black hispanic? CODE AS WHITE OR BLACK AS APPROPRIATE)

85	White
10	Black
3	Other
2	No answer
100	

45.Is your total annual household income before taxes $20,000 or more or is it less than $20,000?

(IF "UNDER" ASK:) Is it over or under $15,000?
(IF "UNDER" ASK:) Is it over or under $10,000?
(IF "OVER" ASK:) Is it over or under $30,000?
(IF "OVER" ASK:) Is it over or under $50,000?

7	Less than $10,000
9	$10,000- $14,999
14	$15,000 - $19,999
16	$20,000 - $29,999
22	$30,000 - $49,999
19	$50,000 and over
13	No answer
100	

46.CHECK RESPONDENT'S SEX:

47	Male
53	Female
100	

47.Would you be willing to have a reporter call you to discuss this topic further? (IF ASKED WHO IS THE SPONSOR, OR WHO WILL BE CALLING SAY: The reporter is from U.S. News and World Report.)

37	Yes
59	No
4	Don't know
100	

PLEASE RECORD AND VERIFY PHONE NUMBER:

☐☐☐ -	☐☐☐ -	☐☐☐☐
AREA CODE	EXCHANGE	NUMBER